The Obedience of Faith - Foundations

The Purpose of the Good

Goodness has a source, not just a definition

"But solid food is for the mature, whose perceptions are trained by practice to discern both good and evil."
(Hebrews 5:14)

http://TeachTheWord.Church

“Why Do You Call Me Good?”

Mark 10:17-18 → Goodness has a source, not just a definition

“Good teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?” **(Mark 10:17)**
“Why do you call me good? No one is good except God alone.”
(Mark 10:18)

Jesus is not denying his own goodness. He is pointing the man to the source.
The man used “good” as a compliment → a measurement. Jesus treats it as an identification.

Goodness is not a free-floating quality people possess on their own.
Anything called good is good because it participates in Him.

The Old Testament said it first:

“I will make all my goodness pass before your face, and I will proclaim the LORD by name before you.” **(Exodus 33:19)**

“Taste and see that the LORD is good!” **(Psalm 34:8)**
Goodness, in Scripture, is met → not merely measured.

The Purpose of the Good Is God's Purpose

Union, not admiration → Genesis 1 to Romans 8



The purpose of the Good is not an abstract ethical puzzle.

It is God's own purpose: to be united with the people He made, and to remake them in His likeness.

Union, not admiration.

God's goal is not people who approve of goodness from a distance, but a family that shares His character → *"the firstborn among many brothers and sisters"* (Rom 8:29).

Anything less → respect, agreement, admiration → falls short of what the Good has purposed.

The Revealing Pattern of Sacrifice and Obedience

Jesus → Perfect Alignment with God's Will and Purpose (The Good)

"Sacrifice and offering you did not desire, but a body you prepared for me… Then I said, 'Here I am; I have come → it is written of me in the scroll of the book → to do your will, O God.'" **(Hebrews 10:5, 7)**

Obedience of Faith **: "I have come to do your will"**

Sacrifice **: the full cost, a body, nothing kept back**

Worship **: perfect heart**

Religion **: perfect form**

Aligned once by Jesus Himself, completely, in Him.

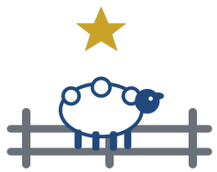
"By that will we have been made holy → once for all." (Heb 10:10)

He completed the stack before He asked you to climb it. **Yours is a thank offering, not a payment. (Rom 12:1-2)**

"I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service. And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is that good and acceptable and perfect ***will of God****."*
(**Romans 12:1-2**)

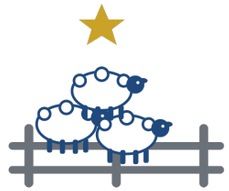
Failures of Perception

Malachi's priests - Saul - Uzzah → they could not see it…





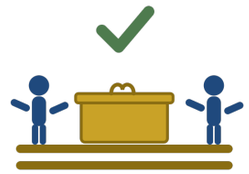
MALACHI — the best kept, the blemished offered.
"You ask, 'How have we offended you?'" **(Mal 1:7)**





SAUL — kept the best of the flock; burned a sacrifice anyway.
"I have done what the Lord said."
(1 Sam 15:13)





UZZAH — a new cart; thirty thousand saw no problem.
"We did not seek him according to the prescribed ordinance."
(1 Chr 15:13)

Not mainly failures of willpower → failures of perception.
Men at layer one or three, sincerely certain they stood at layer four. An untrained perception can't tell the layers apart → **and it can't audit itself.**

"Solid food is for the mature, whose perceptions are trained by practice to discern both good and evil." **(Hebrews 5:14)**

Discernment = telling form from disposition from cost from settled obedience.

The Problem: Devotion Is Invisible

Even to its owner

A disposition cannot be seen.
Love for God, trust, devotion → all invisible.
Not just to your neighbor. To you.

Scripture is full of people certain of their own devotion:

- **Saul**: "I have done what the Lord said" → and believed it (1 Sam 15:13)
- **The priests**: "How have we offended you?" → and meant it (Mal 1:7)
- "**Lord, Lord**…" → and heard *"I never knew you"* (Matt 7:21–23)

Sincerity is real → and unverifiable. Every one of those people passed their own inspection.

> ***"Put yourselves to the test to see if you are in the faith; examine yourselves!"* (2 Cor 13:5)**

So, the question this course answers:

How does the invisible become visible → and how does a person learn to see it?

The Controlling Verse

Hebrews 5:12–14 → maturity is trained perception

"For though you should in fact be teachers by this time, you need someone to teach you the beginning elements of God's utterances. You have gone back to needing milk, not solid food." **(Hebrews 5:12)**

"But solid food is for the mature, whose perceptions are trained by practice to discern both good and evil." **(Hebrews 5:14)**

Three words carry this course: **trained → by practice.**

Discernment is not downloaded at baptism or absorbed from sermons. It is built like a tradesman's eye → repetitions, daily, until perception knows things the mouth can't yet explain.

And notice what the mature discern: **good and evil.**

The course title and the course thesis are the same sentence: maturity is the trained ability to recognize the Good → God's own character → from everything that merely resembles it.

The Road: Twelve Weeks

From the Good, through sacrifice and testing, to commission

Wks 1–3 FOUNDATIONS	The Good · sacrifice · why sincerity isn't enough
Wks 4–6 DISCERNMENT	Two righteousnesses · the Berean method · love in truth
Wks 7–9 TESTING	Covenant tests · the church's tests · living sacrifice
Wks 10–11 GOD'S HOUSE	Apostolic authority · created order
Wk 12 COMMISSION	Households · "by this time → teachers"

Stated before anything is asked of you:

"Therefore, I exhort you, brothers and sisters, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies as a sacrifice → alive, holy, and pleasing to God…" **(Romans 12:1)**

Mercy first. Altar second. Your "Living Sacrifice".

Nothing in this course earns your standing before God; all of it responds to a sacrifice already completed.

The Course Rhythm: Read Like a Berean

Scripture each week → eager, and examining

"They accepted the message with all <u>eagerness</u>, <u>examining</u> the scriptures carefully every day to see if these things were so." **(Acts 17:11)**

- Both halves, every week: *want it to be true → and check that it is*.

For next week, read:

- **Genesis 22:1–19** → What exactly does God ask for, and when does Abraham's faith become visible?
- **Hebrews 11:17–19** → What did Abraham reason, and what did the test prove?
- Document → Faith Tests Across Covenants
- Document → God's Will – Three Observed Types

Next week: Good Intentions Are Not Enough → sincerity cannot substitute for God's revealed will; the question of worship is "Has God spoken?"

"Taste and see that the LORD is good!" (Psalm 34:8)

http://TeachTheWord.Church